- Hence, good nutrition is essential to prevent nutritional deficiency diseases, promotion of health and treatment of deficiency diseases.

Resistance to infection

- A well balanced nutrition prevents infections like tuberculosis. Good nutrition enhances wound healing. Improves resistance of an individual towards infections.

Mortality and morbidity

- Malnutrition leads to increased death rate, infant mortality rate, still births and premature deliveries. Prematurity is the major cause of deaths.
- Over nutrition causes diseases like Obesity, diabetes, hypertension, cardiovascular and renal diseases and causes death.

5.4 Factors affecting food and nutrition

The following factors affects food and nutrition

- Basal metabolic rate
- Weight
- Age
- Sex
- Climate and environment
- Physical activities
- Physiological state
- Socio economic factors
- Cultural factors
    - Life style and food habits
    - Food fads
    - Cooking practices
    - Child rearing practices
- Religion
- Traditional factors
- Food production and distribution.

Food Pyramid

According to Indian Council of Medical Research, foods are grouped as shown in Pyramid according to the requirement for healthy life.



Each food groups is a source of different nutrients. Balanced diet should include all the food groups.





One of the world's healthiest food is lemon. One lemon contains our daily dose of vitamin C it cleanses our liver, boost our immunity and aids in weight loss.

5.5 Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates are the main source of energy for daily activities. Carbohydrates (primarily starches) are the least expensive, the most available, easily obtainable and readily digestible form of nutrient.

Composition of Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates are organic compounds of carbon, hydrogen and oxygen with the latter elements in the ratio of 2: 1. The general formula is $C_6H_{12}O_6$. Carbohydrates are widely

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